Critical values obtained from point-of-care testing are considered reportable incidents due to their immediate impact on patient care, often prompting a change in medical management. These test results fall outside the established normal range and are significant regardless of the patient's current health status. Documenting these critical values and promptly communicating them to the patient's health care provider, typically via telephone, is essential. When relaying test results verbally, verifying that the recipient is authorized to receive patient information is crucial, ensuring they record the results and then having them repeat the information to confirm its accuracy. This ***read-back*** process is vital to prevent any miscommunication. After providing verbal reports, they should be supplemented with an electronic or printed copy of the full report for the official record.

read-back. Read back information to confirm the accuracy of what was written.

Professionalism Tip

Adaptability for a phlebotomy technician is the capacity to adeptly navigate new or evolving circumstances, procedures, and patient requirements within the fast-paced setting of a clinical environment. For instance, when confronted with an unexpected surge of patients requiring blood work during a peak season for illnesses, the phlebotomy technician swiftly reorganizes priorities, aids in streamlining patient flow, and adeptly handles alterations in the workload to preserve high standards of service without compromising the precision and safety of blood draws. Additionally, the phlebotomy technician ensures effective communication by clearly explaining procedures to patients, addressing their concerns, and providing reassurance, all while coordinating with other healthcare staff to ensure seamless patient care.

6.3 CHALLENGE

1. How does a phlebotomy technician's adaptability, in managing unexpected changes in patient volume and workflow while maintaining high service standards, contribute to the efficiency of the clinical environment and the overall patient experience?

6.3 CHALLENGE KEY

1. A phlebotomy technician's adaptability is essential for maintaining efficiency and quality of care in the clinical environment, particularly during periods of high patient volume. When faced with a surge of patients, the technician's ability to quickly reorganize priorities and streamline patient flow is crucial in preventing long wait times and reducing patient anxiety. By adeptly handling changes in workload, the technician ensures that each blood draw is performed with the same level of precision and safety, regardless of the increased demands, but also minimizes the potential for errors that could arise.

Recollection of Specimens

Delays and difficulties in obtaining specimens can lead to frustration for patients and are a potential patient safety concern. Therefore, communication with the health care team provides information on the delay and postponement of treatment until results are obtained from the test ordered. The necessity of specimen relocation must be communicated to all health care team members, including the patient. When a specimen must be recollected, it must be done promptly to avoid delays in diagnosis and treatment. Communicate with the patient by being honest regarding the redraw. Provide empathy and express the importance of the redraw. Importance should be stressed to the patient about the redraw to prevent the delay of diagnosis and treatment. Honesty enhances patient satisfaction and improves patient outcomes. Establishing a rapport with the patient during the first encounter can make a redraw a little easier conversation.